



Safe IV Therapy at Home — Family Preparation Checklist

(Advanced Nursing Care | Narpavi Homecare, Chennai)

When IV therapy is moved from the hospital to the home, **a little preparation makes the process safer, cleaner, and less stressful for everyone.** This checklist helps families get ready before a nurse arrives.

1 Prepare a Clean & Quiet Space

- Choose a well-lit area with a table or stand for IV fluids and supplies.
- Keep pets and small children away during infusion time.
- Ensure good ventilation but no direct fan/AC blowing on the setup.

2 Arrange a Comfortable Seat or Bed

- Patient should sit or lie where the arm can stay still during infusion.
- Provide pillows for arm support and overall comfort.
- Keep a blanket handy in case of chills.

3 Ensure Easy Access to Power & Light

- If infusion pumps or monitors are used, ensure nearby power outlets.
- Keep backup lighting or a torch ready in case of power cuts.

4 Keep Essentials Nearby

- Drinking water, tissues, hand sanitizer.
- Waste bin with lid (for non-sharp waste).
- A stable IV pole or wall hook if recommended by the nurse.

5 Understand Hygiene Expectations

- Everyone present should wash hands or use sanitizer before touching supplies.
- Avoid touching the IV site, tubing, or connectors unless guided by the nurse.
- Maintain a clutter-free surface for sterile supplies.

6 Have Key Documents Ready

- Doctor's prescription & latest discharge summary.
- Allergy list and current medications.
- Previous test reports or imaging (if relevant).

7 Plan for Monitoring

- Thermometer, BP monitor, or pulse oximeter if you have them.
- The nurse will check vitals, but extra monitoring helps with early warning.

8 Know the Red Flags

Call the nurse/doctor immediately if you notice:

- Fever, chills, new pain, or swelling near IV site.
- Leakage, redness, or unusual warmth around catheter.
- Shortness of breath, rash, or sudden discomfort.

9 Communication & Updates

- Assign a family member as primary contact.
- Keep a phone nearby for **24×7 emergency support**: 📞 9600002303.
- NRI families can request WhatsApp video/photo updates.

10 Confirm the Care Plan

- Review infusion schedule, medicines, and expected duration.
- Understand when to escalate or upgrade to **Specialty Care** or **ICU-at-Home** if the condition changes.

✅ Why This Matters

Proper preparation **reduces infection risk, speeds up nursing workflow, and ensures comfort** for the patient. Families feel more confident, and nurses can focus on safe, efficient IV administration.

Narpavi Homecare Advantage:

Verified IV-certified nurses • Doctor-led oversight • WHO hand hygiene compliance • Transparent logs & NRI updates • 24×7 escalation support.